NN-P-530E
May 19, 1977
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. NN-P-530D
July 22, 1968

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PLYWOOD, FLAT PANEL

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal Agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers flat plywood panels.

1.2 Classification. The plywood shall be of the following groups as specified (see 6.2):

Group A - (PS-51) Hardwood and Decorative Plywood.
Group B - (PS-1) Construction and Industrial Plywood.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specification:

PPP-P-1260 - Plywood, Packaging, Packing, and Marking of.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain extra copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Services Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Department of Commerce:

PS-51 - Hardwood and Decorative Plywood.
PS-1 - Construction and Industrial Plywood.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Description. The plywood panels shall be in accordance with PS-51 or PS-1, as applicable.

3.2 Type, grade, species, species group, and sanding. The type, grade, species, species group, and sanding insofar as applicable shall be as specified (see 6.2), and shall be in accordance with the applicable Product Standard.

3.3 Dimensional and ply requirements. The width, length, thickness, and number of plies of the plywood panels shall be as specified (see 6.2) and shall be in accordance with the applicable Product Standard.

3.4 Grade marking. Each panel or piece shall be marked with the appropriate grade marking in accordance with PS-51 or PS-1, as applicable.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requrements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Material inspection. The contractor is responsible for insuring that materials used are manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with referenced specifications and standards.

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4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

(a) Quality conformance inspection (see 4.3).
(b) Inspection of packaging (see 4.4).

4.3 Quality conformance inspection. The contractor is responsible for insuring that the veneers used in the manufacture of the plywood and the plywood panels as manufactured are examined and tested in accordance with the Product Standard as applicable.

4.4 Inspection of packaging. Inspection of packaging requirements shall be in accordance with PPP-P-1260.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Intermediate packing. Intermediate packing shall be applicable to civil agency procurement only and shall be in accordance with PPP-P-1260, Level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Civil agencies. Packing shall be in accordance with PPP-P-1260, Level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.2 Military agencies. Packing shall be Level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2), in accordance with PPP-P-1260, and exceptions as follows:

(a) Battens shall be nominal 3 x 4 inches instead of 2 x 4 inches for Levels A and B.
(b) Breaking strength of strapping shall be 2,800 pounds for flat and 2,000 pounds for round for Level A; 2,000 pounds for flat and 1,700 pounds for round for Level B.
(c) Level B pack shall be strapped the same as Level A except that only one centrally located lengthwise strap shall be used.
(d) Corrugated fiberboard shall not be used as waster sheets for Level B.
(e) Machine-fed edge protectors, used in conjunction with fully automated strapping systems, shall be a minimum 5/8 inch as measured on the outside of the leg.
(f) When loaded on open carriers, plywood shall be completely protected from the elements with durable covers or shrouds.

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5.3 Marking. Marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with PPP-P-1260. For military agencies, in addition to the identification marking required by PPP-P-1260, each bundle or stack shall have the National Stock Number, item description, level of protection and date, grade of plywood, and cube of bundle or stack.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Plywood is intended for use in making cabinets, signs, siding of buildings, concrete forms, furniture, flooring, boats, sheathing, containers, pallets, and for general construction work.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Group required (see 1.2).
(c) Type, grade, species, species group, and sanding required (see 3.2).
(d) Dimensions and plies required (see 3.3).
(e) Levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.2.1 and 5.2.2).

6.3 The following is descriptive of the plywood types and grades as covered by the product standards.

6.3.1 PS-51 (hardwood plywood).

6.3.1.1 Types

(a) Technical type, fully waterproof bond. The plywood is designed to give equal strength in both directions of length and width. The glue line is waterproof and unaffected by micro-organisms. The bond shall withstand full weather and water exposure.

(b) Type I, exterior, fully waterproof bond. The bond will withstand full weather exposure and is unaffected by micro-organisms.

(c) Type II, interior, water resistant bond. The bond will withstand occasional wetting and drying.

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(d) Type III, interior, moisture resistant bond. The bond is only for use where the plywood will not be subject to water, dampness, or high humidities.

6.3.1.2 Grades. Numerical grades from 1 through 4 are used to designate the quality of veneer plies, with 1 signifying a smooth and nearly unblemished surface. Grade 4 veneer is a backing grade with blemishes and specified openings allowed. A premium grade, designated by the letter A, has the same characteristics as Grade 1, in addition to having different pieces of the face edge-matched.

6.3.2 PS-1 (construction and industrial).

6.3.2.1 Types.

(a) Interior. The glue bond is of interior or intermediate durability, not waterproof thus limiting use of such plywood to interior applications.

(b) Interior with exterior glue. Plywood of interior type bonded with waterproof glue and suitable for exposure to service conditions of high moisture content or prolonged construction delays.

(c) Waterproof glue bond will withstand repeated wetting thus permitting exterior use.

6.3.2.2 Grades. Veneer quality is designated by the letters A through D, with A denoting a smooth, unblemished surface which is good for painting. Succeeding letters denote veneers having more defects; Grade D surfaces will have many openings as long as strength or serviceability is not affected. A premium quality surface, designated by the letter N, must have edge-matched pieces in addition to all other features of a Grade A panel.

6.4 Plywood for containers. Plywood for single use boxes and sheathed crates normally will be Grade 3-4 or Grade C-D in accordance with PS-51 and PS-1 respectively. Waterproof glue will normally be required because of the likelihood of a certain amount of outdoor exposure during transit and storage. Reusable containers such as chests, will require better grades of plywood to permit painting and better appearance.

6.5 Treatment. Only plywood with exterior glue should be used when fire retardant or preservative treatments are applied. Each piece so treated shall bear appropriate certification marking in accordance with

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American Wood Preservers Institute, American Wood Preservers Bureau, Underwriters Laboratories, or other applicable certifying organizations.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:
Army - ME
Navy - YD
Air Force - 99

Review activities:
Army - GL, EA, SM, MI
Navy - SH, OS
DSA -CS, DP
DNA - DS

User activity:
Navy - MC
DSA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

GSA-FSS

Project No. 5530-0034

Preparing activity:
Army - ME

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